

SafetySense

George Teifel · Mary Teifel

UNM & CNM APP CONTEST 2026

WHO WE ARE

SafetySense calls for help when you can't.

George Teifel

University of New Mexico

Senior · Electrical Engineering

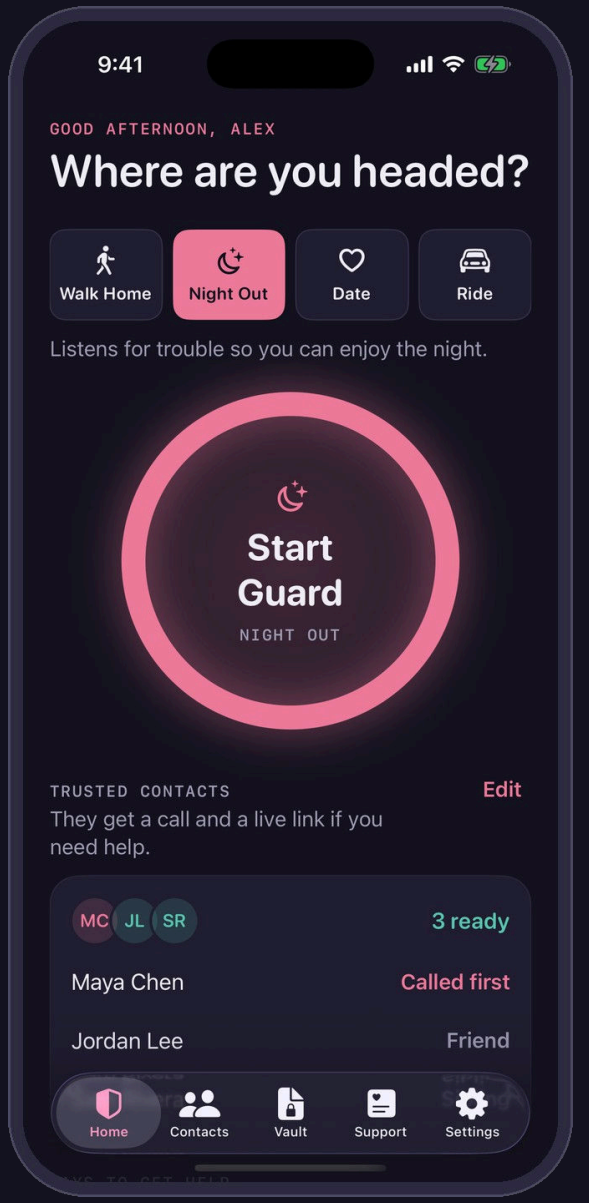
Built the iOS app and the backend

Mary Teifel

Central New Mexico Community College

Dual credit student · Mechanical Engineering

Research, design and the app's wording



THE PROBLEM

Most safety apps wait for you to press a button or set a timer

70%

of 298 women reported significant tonic immobility, an involuntary freeze, during sexual assault

Möller et al., Acta Obstet Gynecol Scand, 2017 (n = 298)

Freezing is involuntary

It is a normal response, not a choice.

Phones get taken, broken or switched off

A dead phone sends nothing.

Speaking isn't always possible

Even texting 911 takes a phone in your hand.

What if you can't press the button?

“Most safety apps”: based on the documentation of the apps we reviewed. We did not test them.

OUR ANSWER

You turn on a Guard. If you can't respond, it acts for you.

One tap before you go

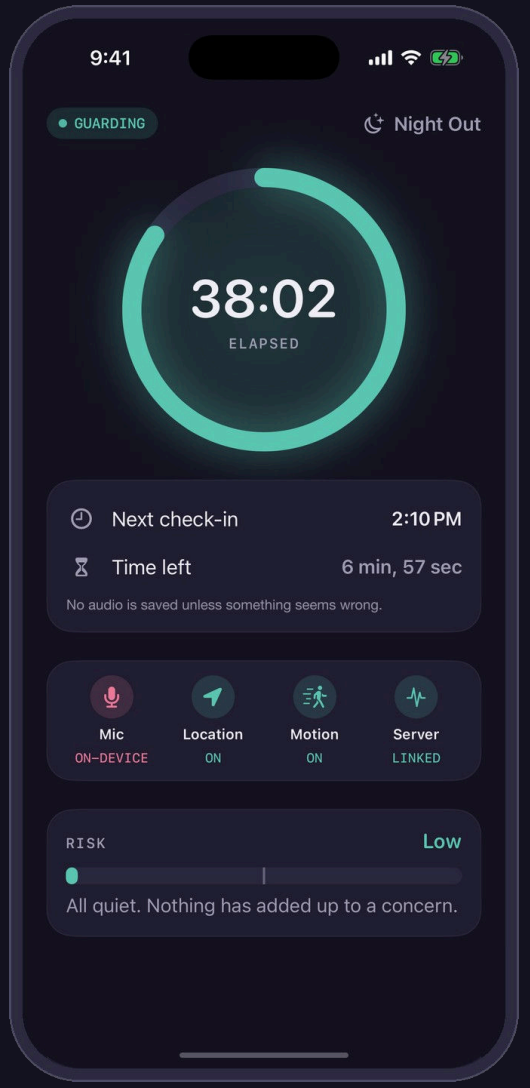
A walk home, a night out, a date or a ride.

It pays attention for you

A scream, breaking glass, your safe word, a fall.

If you can't respond, it gets help

First your people, then professional dispatch.



It only listens while a Guard is on, and the listening happens on your phone.

Watch three things.

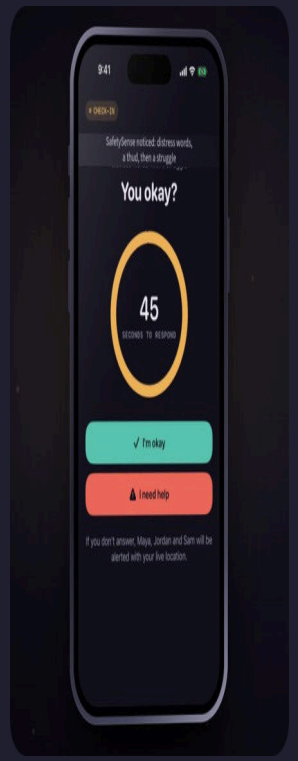
1. It asks before it alerts.
2. What her friend sees, and who's called if no one answers.
3. What happens if someone makes her cancel, or breaks her phone.





WHAT YOU JUST SAW

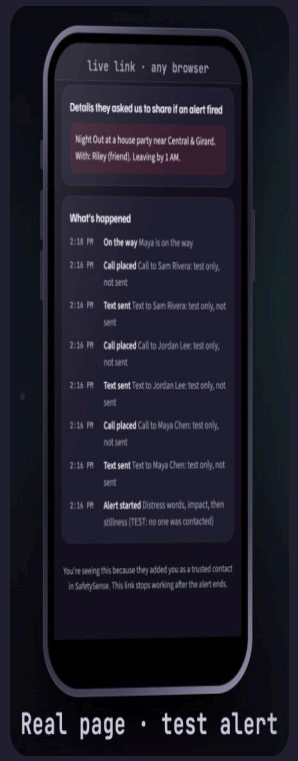
The app is real. One part of that was simulated.



REAL

Our app

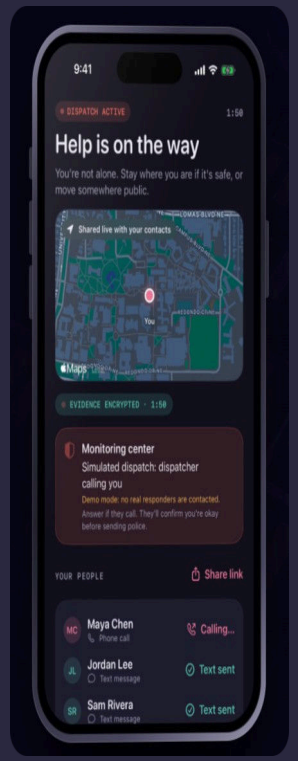
Those screens are the app itself, in demo mode.



REAL

Calls and the page

It makes real phone calls, and her friend's page is a real web page.



SIMULATED

Dispatch

No police were contacted. It's a test system for now.

The waiting is sped up, Ava and Maya are animated characters, and text messages don't arrive yet on our trial account.

WHAT IT DOES

Four kinds of nights. One tap to start.



Walk home

Shares your location with one friend and checks that you got there.



Night out

Listens for trouble, checks in on you, and reminds you about your drink.



First date

Keeps who you're meeting sealed. Your friend sees it only if an alert fires.



Ride

Notices if the ride leaves the route or stops where it shouldn't.



Need a way out?

A fake call gives you a reason to leave. And a duress PIN looks like a cancel, but keeps help coming.

DESIGN AND EXPERIENCE

Designed for the worst night of someone's life

Calm words, never blame

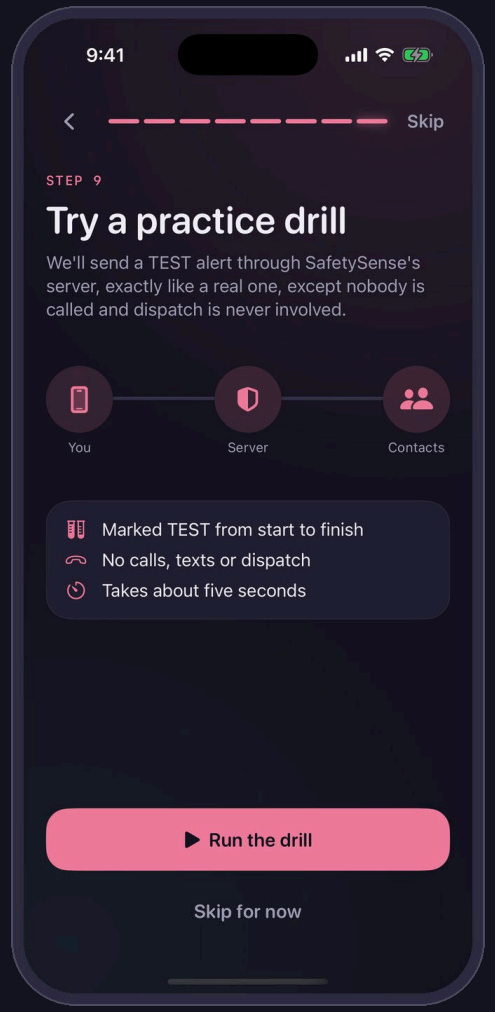
Written to be calm and never blaming.

Your first alert is a drill

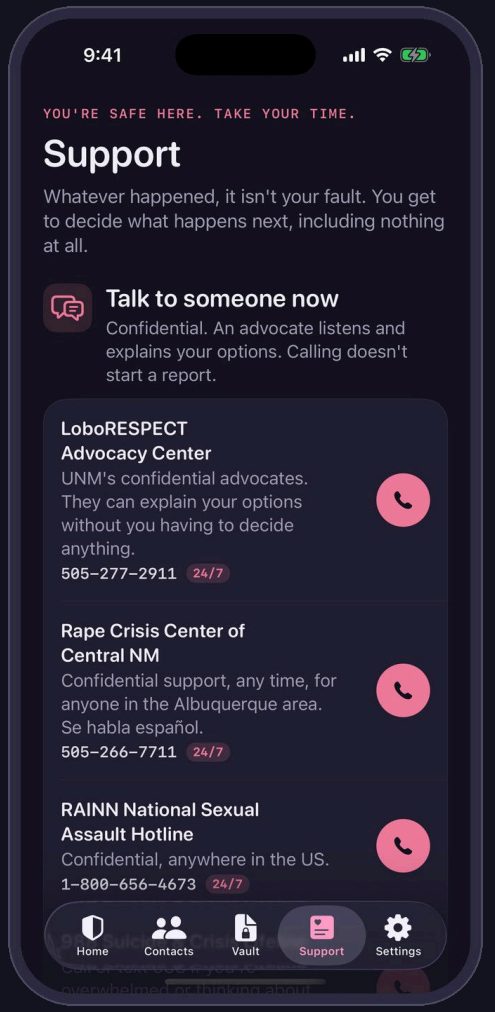
Onboarding ends with a practice run marked TEST.

Afterward, you choose

An advocate, medical care, reporting, or keeping it private.



The practice drill



Support, afterward

TRUST

An app that listens has to earn your trust



It only listens when you turn it on

Never in the background, never all day.



No audio is saved unless an alert fires

Then it's locked on your phone before it goes anywhere.



You decide who hears it

It opens with your Face ID. No ads, no trackers.

The link your friends get is built to expire after the alert.

ORIGINALITY

Others have pieces. We connected the chain.

	UNM Safe	Noonlight	bSafe	Apple built-in	SafetySense
Notices distress on its own	–	Crash (paid)	Voice phrase	Crash; fall on Watch	✓ **Sound, motion, context**
Acts when the phone goes dark	–	Not documented	Not listed	Check In, timing varies	✓ **Our server notices**
Duress PIN (fake cancel)	–	–	Not listed	–	✓ **The two PINs you saw**
Professional dispatch	Call UNMPD	✓	–	911 call	✓ **Yes (test system)**
Live location to a friend	✓	✓	✓	✓ Check In	✓

From each product's documentation; not tested by us. These are four tools a student could already have.
Their columns are shipped products. Ours is a prototype; dispatch runs in a test system.

WHERE WE ARE

What works today, and what we still have to prove

Today

- A working iPhone app
- Real calls and a real page for your friend
- A private test build, not public yet

Not proven yet

- Real, noisy places like a bar
- A full run on a real phone
- Live dispatch, which needs our partner's sign-off

Next

- Tests with UNM and CNM students
- Advocates review our wording
- A student pilot, then a campus partnership

SAFETYSENSE

When you can't call for help, SafetySense does.

SafetySense supplements 911. It never replaces it.

George Teifel UNM **Mary Teifel** CNM

Thank you. We'd love your questions.

